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LETTER DATED 10 APRIL 1972 FROM THE FRENCH REPUBLIC
OF THE KHMER REPUBLIC TO THE UNITED NATIONS ADDRESSED TO THE
PRESIDENT OF THE SECURITY COUNCIL.

On instructions from my Government and further to my letter No. 2847/DOP/2501 of 8 December 1971 (document S/10450 of 13 December 1971), I have the honour to communicate the following to you for the information of the members of the Security Council.

On 1 January 1972, a group of Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese burst into the pagoda of Preah Puth Thmor Kôn, Prey Nhat commune, Song Pisey district, Kompong Speu province, Cambodia, and arrested the chief of the pagoda Nôn Nôn, the religious assistant Oak Ouch and an elderly woman named Sim. They led these persons away to the village of Chhouk Sâr in the same district.

On the way, after tying up the venerable chief of the pagoda and the other male victim, they killed the woman named Sim, near the village of Thlok Thung, in the same district. They took the two others to Chhouk Sâr to have them killed there.

While Oak Ouch was being killed, however, the venerable Nôn Nôn was able to escape. Profoundly distressed by these crimes of the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese, he has decided to abandon the monastic life and enlist in the Khmer National Armed Forces.

On 5 January 1972, Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese aggressors penetrated into the village of Taing, Bantêk commune, Chhlong Prey district, Kompong Chhnang province, Cambodia, and arrested and took away with them two inhabitants named Neak Thóng and Prek Chéang, whom they then murdered in cold blood just outside the village.

On 6 January 1972, Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese aggressors killed, 200 metres from his home, an inhabitant named Neak May, domiciled at Pre Thachy, Chéng Hông commune, Taek Pheo district, Kompong Chhnang province, Cambodia.

In the night of 7/8 January 1972, a group estimated to consist of eight Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese burst into the village of Samrong Thom, Phae commune, Baribeur district, Kompong Chhnang province, Cambodia, arrested Pal Sam and tied him up near his home for the purpose of killing him.

The victim's brother, the venerable Fai Bokhan, who pleaded with the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese aggressors to release his brother, was shot dead by them on the spot.

On 17 January 1970, at about 2 p.m., Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese aggressors fired on the inhabitants of the region of Peng Riell, Kompong Thom province, Cambodia, hitting a farmer named Chin who was working in the rice-fields.

On 19 January 1970, at about 4 a.m., an inhabitant named Phin Yem living at Thounk, Khon Rang commune, Battambang district, Kompong Chhnang province, Cambodia, was arrested and killed on the road leading to the town of Kompong Chhnang by an unknown member of Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese.

In the night of 20/21 January 1970, at about 5 p.m., an unknown member of Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese suddenly appeared at Tsoi Thart, Kien Svay district, Kamal province, Cambodia, and murdered a teacher named Long Khin while he was dining at his home with the members of his family.

In the night of 21/22 January 1970, Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese aggressors aimed heavy fire from 75-mm guns at the town of Siemreap, wounding seven people. The wounded were a woman named See At and six pupils named Touch Vandy, Sok Sapannara, Geng Samaly, Tan Vanna, Yem Samodl and Tong Hamb.

On 26 January 1970, two Khmer families consisting of 12 persons, who were fleeing from the commune of Ksa. Eok of Moung Ranyay, Battambang province, Cambodia, in order to escape the atrocities of the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese invaders and seek refuge in the chief town of Moung Ranyay, were arrested on the way by a group of Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese.

According to the latest information, two of these refugees - Kan Saeng and Khin Munk - have been murdered. The fate of the 10 others is still not known.

I wish once again to bring before world opinion the strong and vehement protest of the Government and people of the Khmer Republic against these new criminal acts committed in Khmer territory by the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namese against the Khmer civilian and religious population.

The Government of the Khmer Republic holds the Government of the Democratic Republic of Viet-Nam and the so-called Provisional Revolutionary Government of South Viet-Nam (Viet-Cong) wholly responsible for all the consequences of these acts and reserves the right to adopt appropriate measures for the defence of the civilian and religious population and of the principles of freedom recognized in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

I should be grateful if you would have this communication circulated as a Security Council document.

(Signed) TRUNG CANH
Permanent Representative of the Khmer Republic
to the United Nations